CONSTITUTION AND BY-LAWS
UNITED STUDENTS WORKING FOR ADVOCACY AND GROWTH (USWAG)

PREAMBLE

We, the members of USWAG – United Students Working for Advocacy and Growth, bound by our collective desire to uphold youth voice, promote mental health and wellness, and lead environmental advocacy, hereby establish this Constitution and By-Laws. Inspired by our duty as student leaders and changemakers, we dedicate ourselves to creating inclusive spaces, raising awareness, and fostering sustainable and participatory leadership for the betterment of the student body and our communities. Guided by these principles, we commit to uphold unity, accountability, and service in all our endeavors at Northwest Samar State University.

ARTICLE I – NAME

Section 1. The name of this organization shall be **USWAG – United Students Working for Advocacy and Growth** (and shall be considered as an institutional affiliation) of Northwest Samar State University.
Section 2. USWAG shall represent a cause-driven student organization dedicated to leadership, advocacy, and developmental initiatives within and beyond the university.

ARTICLE II – PURPOSE

Section 1. The purpose of the organization shall be:

a. To promote meaningful youth voice and participation in student leadership and governance.
b. To foster awareness, compassion, and responsiveness to mental health and wellness concerns within the university community.
c. To cultivate environmental leadership and sustainable practices through green initiatives and student-led environmental programs.
d. To support holistic student growth through civic, academic, and developmental projects.
e. To maintain a presence beyond student elections through sustained programs for the common good.

Section 2. The organization shall advocate for the following core causes:

a. **Youth Voice and Participation** – Promoting meaningful student involvement in decision-making, governance, and civic leadership.
b. **Mental Health and Wellness Awareness** – Advancing mental health literacy, peer support systems, and wellness campaigns across the university.
c. **Environmental Leadership** – Leading sustainability efforts and environmental stewardship initiatives among the student body.

ARTICLE III - MEMBERSHIP

Section 1. Membership is open to all bona fide students of Northwest Samar State University who support the vision and mission of USWAG.
Section 2. To become a member, a student shall: a. Submit a completed membership form; b. Pay the membership fee as determined by the officers and approved by the adviser; and c. Attend an orientation or onboarding session.
Section 3. Membership is valid for one academic year and is renewable annually

ARTICLE IV – RIGHTS AND PRIVILEGES OF MEMBERS

Section 1. All members of USWAG shall be entitled to the following rights:

a. The right to vote and be voted upon during elections;
b. The right to express opinions, suggestions, and ideas during organizational meetings, planning sessions, and discussions, in accordance with the responsibilities of their position or membership role;
c. The right to access all relevant and approved organizational records, reports, and documents.

Section 2. Members shall also enjoy the privilege of participating in seminars, workshops, symposia, forums, and other activities organized by USWAG that contribute to personal growth, community involvement, and the vibrancy of the organization.

ARTICLE V – DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES OF MEMBERS

Section 1. Every member of USWAG is expected to be an active, enthusiastic, and committed participant in the organization's initiatives. Members shall contribute their time, talents, and resources to advance the mission and advocacies of USWAG.

Section 2. Members shall respect and adhere to the organization's policies, guidelines, and code of conduct as prescribed by the Constitution and its duly elected officers.

Section 3. All members must be aware of their individual responsibilities and accountability in supporting the organization’s goals and ensuring the success of its programs and projects.

Article VI – **Officers**

Section 1. The USWAG Organization should have the following constituents;

a. One (1) **President**

b. One (1) **Vice-President**

c. One (1) **Secretary**

d. One (1) **Treasurer**

e. One (1) **Auditor**

f. One (1) **Business Manager**

g. One (1) **Public Relation Officer per college/department**

Section 2. Duties and Responsibilities. Each officer shall carry out responsibilities that uphold the organization's mission and ensure the effective implementation of its programs, operations, and advocacy work. Officers are expected to work collaboratively, lead by example, and fulfill their respective roles with integrity and dedication.

a. President

- Serve as the official representative of the organization.
- Preside over meetings and enforce the Constitution and By-Laws.
- Call for special meetings when necessary.
- Submit an annual report at the end of the academic year.

b. Vice President
- Assume the duties of the President in their absence.
- Supervise and coordinate the work of all officers and committees as delegated by the President.

c. Secretary
- Record and keep minutes of all meetings.
- Maintain organizational records and official documents.
- Prepare the roster of members and handle correspondence.
- Notify members of scheduled meetings.

d. Treasurer
- Manage and safeguard the organization's funds and properties.
- Collect dues and fees as approved by the body.
- Prepare and present financial statements every semester.\

e. Auditor
- Examine and audit financial records.
- Prepare and submit audit reports every semester.
- Coordinate with the Treasurer to ensure accuracy and transparency.

f. Business Manager
- Source and purchase necessary materials for organizational activities.
- Coordinate with the Secretary, Treasurer, and Auditor regarding purchases.

g. Public Relations Officer (PRO)
- Disseminate announcements and publicity materials through bulletins and social media.
- Foster engagement and model good conduct to members, especially lower years.

Section 3. Only regular students of Northwest Samar State University shall be eligible to hold any officer position in the organization.

Section 4. All officers shall serve for a term of one academic year.

ARTICLE VII – MEETINGS, QUORUM, AND ELECTION

Section 1. The organization shall hold regular meetings every last week of the month. Special meetings may be called by the President when important matters arise that require immediate attention.

Section 2. A quorum shall be constituted by one-half (1/2) of the total active membership plus one.

Section 3. Elections for a new set of officers shall be conducted after the Institutional Election at the end of each academic year.

ARTICLE VIII – ADVISERS

Section 1. The adviser of the organization shall be a regular faculty member of Northwest Samar State University.

Section 2. The adviser shall have the following responsibilities and accountabilities:
a. Facilitate the annual planning of organizational activities.

b. Plan and support capacity-building trainings for effective organizational management.
c. Attend meetings and major events organized by USWAG.
d. Guide the preparation and submission of terminal reports to the SARS Office.
e. Oversee the accreditation and re-accreditation processes of the organization.
f. Serve as the mentor and guardian of the organization under the principle of “In Loco Parentis.”

ARTICLE IX - **Amendments**

Section 1. Amendments may be proposed in writing by any member of the organization.

Section 2. Any proposed amendment must be reviewed by the officers and approved by a majority vote during a general assembly where a quorum is present.

Article X – **Effectivity**

Section 1. This Constitution shall take effect immediately upon ratification by the majority of USWAG members.

Ratified this ____ day of _____, _____ at ***Northwest Samar State University***, Main Campus, Calbayog City.